CASH TO COMPANY

Item Bank

"Launch-ready entrepreneurship"

Per-unit quiz / test items · 4 units · ETS-quality alignment to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS

Grade 12 — Cash to Company Item Bank

Year theme: *Launch-ready entrepreneurship.* This bank covers all four Grade 12 units (Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal · The full financial pack · Launch, brand, and compliance · Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense). Items use full-stack venture scenario style — three statements, runway, unit economics, ownership structure, premortem. Distractors target the Grade 12 Common Misconceptions table. No family-money probes; "for a hypothetical" framing throughout. Cash's Grade 12 voice: "*A well-defended shelve is worth more than a poorly defended launch*."

Unit 1: Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal

MC1. "A founder's portfolio (3 ventures compared) is..."

A. A way to look impressive · B. A thinking artifact: forces honest comparison of fit, market, and capital across alternatives · C. A list of products · D. Optional

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.11-12.1 — Argument writing.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 12):** *I can deliver a portfolio defense in which I explain the businesses I would and wouldn't start, with reasons grounded in market, fit, and capital.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*More ventures = more chance of success*" — corrects.

MC2. "In a founder's journal entry, the most useful prompt is..."

A. 'How do I feel today' · B. 'What did I believe when I started this week, what changed, and what's the evidence' · C. 'Who annoyed me' · D. 'What's next on my to-do list'

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CASEL Self-Awareness + Responsible Decision-Making.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 12):** *I can produce a "founder's journal" (10+ entries) showing my idea evolution, evidence collected, and one pivot with the reasoning behind it.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Journal = diary*" — corrects.

MC3. "A 'pivot' in a founder's journal is documented as..."

A. A change · B. Pre-pivot hypothesis + evidence that disconfirmed it + new hypothesis + a falsifiable test · C. A new idea · D. A retreat

Answer: B · **Standard:** *NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-1 — Analyze a major global challenge to specify qualitative and quantitative criteria.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 12):** *I can produce a "founder's journal" showing my idea evolution, evidence collected, and one pivot with the reasoning behind it.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A pivot is failure*" — corrects.

SA1. "Compare 3 hypothetical ventures across 4 criteria: market size, founder fit, capital required, time to first dollar. Recommend ONE with reasoning."

Model answer: "*V1 (custom 3D phone stands): Market — local school + alumni networks (~5k addressable); Fit — high (3 yr maker experience); Capital — low ($200 printer + materials); Time-to-first-dollar — 2 weeks. V2 (AI study app): Market — large but crowded; Fit — medium (1 semester of coding); Capital — medium ($500 cloud + tools); TTFD — 6+ months. V3 (peer SAT prep): Market — local seniors (~200); Fit — high (1450 SAT score, taught 4 cousins); Capital — minimal; TTFD — 3 weeks. RECOMMEND V3: highest fit × lowest capital × fastest cash. V1 is a strong second; V2 is high-risk relative to current skill stack.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All 3 ventures × 4 criteria filled with specifics; recommendation grounded. - **2:** All filled but one criterion vague. - **1:** Recommendation without comparison.

SA2. "Write 4 founder's-journal entries (1-3 sentences each) covering 4 weeks of one venture. Each entry must show evidence + something that changed."

Model answer: "*WK1: Believed parents pay $40 for SAT prep tutoring; verified — 4 of 5 parents agreed at $35-50; tightened to $40. WK2: Believed weekday evenings best; one parent flagged Sat morning as more reliable for athlete-students. WK3: Tested Sat morning vs. Tue evening — Sat had 100% attendance, Tue lost 1 of 4 — Sat wins. WK4: Surprise — students preferred 60-min sessions to 90-min (concentration drop after 60); resized package + cut session count from 8 to 12 shorter sessions for same revenue.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** 4 entries each with evidence + one change. - **2:** 4 entries, 3 with evidence + change. - **1:** Entries are diary-style.

Performance Task: Venture Portfolio + 4 Founder's Journal Entries (90 min over 2 sessions).

Child compares 3 ventures across 4 criteria, recommends one, AND writes the first 4 founder's-journal entries. **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 12): (1) 3×4 comparison filled with specifics, (2) recommendation grounded in market+fit+capital, (3) journal entries show evidence + change. **Strand outcome:** BAVC + PSIG.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Of your 3 ventures, which would you SHELVE? Write the shelve-defense (1 paragraph): why this is the right call, what would have to change for it to come back, what you keep from it.*" Targets the Grade 12 Cash voice — "a well-defended shelve is worth more than a poorly defended launch."

Unit 2: The full financial pack

MC1. "The 3 financial statements that 'together tell the truth' are..."

A. P&L, payroll, taxes · B. P&L, cash flow, balance sheet · C. Revenue, expenses, profit · D. P&L, budget, forecast

Answer: B · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-2 — Develop a system for keeping and using financial records.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 12):** *I can build a complete startup financial pack (P&L, cash flow, balance sheet sketch, runway, unit economics) and walk a non-finance adult through it.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*If my P&L is profitable, I'm fine*" — corrects.

MC2. "Runway = current cash / monthly burn. With $12,000 cash and $3,000/month burn, runway is..."

A. 3 months · B. 4 months · C. 6 months · D. 12 months

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math S-MD.B.5 / S-MD.B.7 — Use probability to evaluate outcomes of decisions.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 12):** *I can build a complete startup financial pack with runway.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Runway = revenue x months*" — corrects: 12,000/3,000 = 4.

MC3. "Unit economics tell you..."

A. Total revenue · B. Whether each customer makes you money on a contribution-margin basis (revenue per unit minus variable cost per unit) · C. Profit margin · D. Tax bill

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CEE Standard 6 (Protecting and Insuring), Grade 12 — People can choose to accept risk or to take steps to protect themselves.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 12):** *I can build a complete startup financial pack with unit economics.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Unit econ = total economics*" — corrects.

SA1. "Build a simplified financial pack for a hypothetical $40 SAT-tutoring venture: 30 customers × $40 = $1,200/month revenue; variable cost $4/session × 12 sessions × 30 customers = $1,440. Spot the unit-economics issue and propose a fix."

Model answer: "*UNIT ECON: package is $40 for 12 sessions = $3.33 per session revenue. Variable cost: $4/session. CM per session = $3.33 - $4 = -$0.67. NEGATIVE CM. Fix: raise price to $48 ($4/session = break-even) or $60 ($5/session = $1 CM); OR cut variable cost by reducing materials per session. The package as priced LOSES money on every customer; this is the kind of math that catches you in unit econ but never in revenue.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Spots the negative CM, computes it correctly, AND proposes a fix that restores positive CM. - **2:** Spots the issue, fix vague. - **1:** Misses the issue.

SA2. "Compute runway with: $9,000 cash, $2,500/month burn, $800/month revenue. State the runway AND name 2 levers that would extend it."

Model answer: "*Net burn = $2,500 - $800 = $1,700/month. Runway = $9,000 / $1,700 ≈ 5.3 months. LEVERS: (1) Raise revenue to $1,500/month (cuts net burn to $1,000, runway becomes 9 months — 70% extension). (2) Cut burn by $500 (recurring software, advertising) — net burn $1,200, runway 7.5 months. Revenue growth has more leverage than expense cuts here because revenue compounds in subsequent months while expense cuts are one-time.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Net burn computed correctly, runway computed, 2 levers with quantified impact. - **2:** Computation right, levers vague. - **1:** Math wrong.

Performance Task: Complete Financial Pack (90 min over 2 sessions).

Child builds a complete financial pack for the Capstone venture: P&L, 12-month cash flow forecast, balance sheet sketch (assets/liabilities/equity), runway, and unit economics. Walks a non-finance adult through it in a 10-minute "explain-it" session. **Rubric:** Budget Project Rubric (Grade 12): (1) all 5 elements present, (2) three-statement consistency (P&L, cash flow, balance sheet align), (3) explain-it session lands with the listener (they can paraphrase the runway and unit econ back). **Strand outcome:** MFL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Your unit economics show CM of $4 and CAC of $6. Diagnose this: is the venture broken, or is it a stage problem? What changes by Month 12?*" Targets payback-period thinking.

Unit 3: Launch, brand, and compliance

MC1. "For a real launch, the minimum to count as 'launched' is..."

A. A landing page · B. A working brand + landing page + at least 5 real customer interactions (not friend-pity-purchases) · C. A logo · D. Social media posts

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4 — Present information.* · **Strand outcome (CBM, 12):** *I can launch a venture (or convincing simulation) with a working brand, website/landing page, and at least 5 real customer interactions.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*An LLC and a business plan = ready to launch*" — corrects.

MC2. "On a 1-page legal/ethical checklist, the LEAST important to confirm is..."

A. Business registration · B. Sales tax / seller's permit · C. Terms of service / privacy / payment safety · D. Logo color palette

Answer: D · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 5 (Risk Management and Insurance), Benchmark 12-3 — Evaluate the cost and benefit of various types of insurance.* · **Strand outcome (ESL, 12):** *I can produce a 1-page legal/ethical checklist for my venture (registration, sales tax, terms of service, privacy, payment safety) and confirm what's done.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Compliance = paperwork*" — corrects.

MC3. "For a hypothetical real launch, 'real customer interactions' means..."

A. Friends posting nice comments · B. Strangers (or friends-of-friends) paying real money OR signing up with a verified email after seeing the offer · C. Family encouraging you · D. Influencer outreach

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CASEL Relationship Skills.* · **Strand outcome (CBM, 12):** *I can launch a venture (or convincing simulation) with a working brand, website/landing page, and at least 5 real customer interactions.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Real customers = anyone who likes your post*" — corrects.

SA1. "Write a 1-page legal/ethical checklist for a hypothetical online tutoring venture. Include 5 items + status (DONE / IN PROGRESS / NOT YET) + the consequence of skipping."

Model answer: "*1. Business registration (sole prop or LLC) — IN PROGRESS — without it, personal-asset exposure. 2. Sales tax / seller's permit — DONE (services may not require in many states; verified for [state]). 3. Terms of service — NOT YET — without TOS, payment disputes have no contract anchor. 4. Privacy policy (collecting student emails + parent contact) — NOT YET — required for COPPA if any users are under 13; serious compliance risk. 5. Payment safety (using Stripe, not personal Venmo) — DONE — keeps personal finances separate, avoids tax-reporting confusion.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All 5 with status + specific consequence per item. - **2:** All 5 with status, consequences vague. - **1:** Fewer than 5 OR no status.

SA2. "Define '5 real customer interactions' for your launch: who, what counts, what doesn't, AND a documentation method."

Model answer: "*WHO: Strangers or friends-of-friends (NOT immediate family/best friends) discovered through ads, search, or referral. COUNTS: paid ≥$1 OR submitted a verified-email form after seeing the full offer including price. DOESN'T COUNT: encouraging comment, follow, like, 'I'd buy it' without payment, family member buying out of love. DOCUMENTATION: Stripe transaction log + email export from Mailchimp; both are timestamped and tamper-evident; 5 entries minimum, screenshot each.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All 4 elements specific (who / counts / doesn't / documentation). - **2:** 3 of 4 specific. - **1:** Generic.

Performance Task: Working Launch (4-week deployment).

Child launches the Capstone venture with: a working brand (1-page brand guide applied), a landing page, AND at least 5 real customer interactions documented. Produces a 1-page legal/ethical checklist with status. **Rubric:** Pitch Presentation Rubric (Grade 12) + Business Plan Rubric: (1) brand guide applied to landing page, (2)

5 real customer interactions documented (not friend-pity), (3) checklist covers 5 items with status. **Strand outcome:** CBM + ESL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Your 5 customer interactions came from one channel (school group chat). What's the risk of single-channel acquisition for a Year-1 venture, and what's the cheapest second-channel test you could run in 2 weeks?*" Anchors channel diversification.

Unit 4: Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense

MC1. "A 90-day operating plan should include..."

A. Aspirations · B. Weekly priorities + owner + metrics with variance reporting · C. A logo refresh · D. Hiring plans

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math S-MD.B.5 — Use probability to evaluate outcomes of decisions.* · **Strand outcome (OSO, 12):** *I can write and follow a 90-day operating plan with weekly priorities, owner, and metrics, and report variance honestly.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A plan is a vision document*" — corrects.

MC2. "A 'Launch or Learn' decision means..."

A. Launch is success; Learn is failure · B. Both are real decisions: Launch with evidence to back it OR Learn (shelve/pivot/transfer) with evidence and a personal next step · C. Launch always · D. Learn always

Answer: B · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1 — Apply reliable information and systematic decision making.* · **Strand outcome (LRCI, 12):** *I can produce a final "Launch or Learn" decision for my Capstone venture with evidence, alternatives, and a personal next step (start, shelve, transfer).* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Shelving is failing*" — corrects directly.

MC3. "A founder's leadership statement should include..."

A. A motto · B. Values + decision rules + the kind of teammate I aim to be · C. A bio · D. Positions held

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CASEL Self-Awareness.* · **Strand outcome (LTO, 12):** *I can write a "founder's leadership statement" with values, decision rules, and the kind of teammate I aim to be — and present it.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Leadership statement = mission statement*" — corrects.

SA1. "Write a 4-week section of a 90-day operating plan for the Capstone venture: weekly priority, owner, target metric, and a variance entry for week 1 (planned vs. actual)."

Model answer: "*WK1 — Priority: validate $48 price point. Owner: me. Target: 5 paid sessions at $48 by Friday. Variance: planned 5, actual 3 — 60% of plan. Cause: Wed*

parent meeting cancelled due to school closure; will rerun in WK2. WK2 — Priority: launch group-rate option (3-pack at $130). Owner: me. Target: 2 group-rate signups. WK3 — Priority: collect 5 testimonials with parent permission. Owner: me. Target: 5 testimonials filed. WK4 — Priority: month-1 review + decide on rate-card v2. Owner: me. Target: variance memo + rate-card v2 published."

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All 4 weeks with priority+owner+metric, variance entry has cause. - **2:** All 4 weeks, variance entry vague. - **1:** Fewer than 4 weeks.

SA2. "Write a Launch-or-Learn decision for your Capstone venture. Include: decision (launch/shelve/transfer), evidence, alternatives considered, AND a personal next step regardless of decision."

Model answer: "*DECISION: LAUNCH at reduced scope. EVIDENCE: 12 paid sessions in 30 days at $48 (target was 10), CM positive at $43/session, NPS 8.5/10 from 9 students. ALTERNATIVES CONSIDERED: (a) Full-time SAT business — rejected because senior year + early college require boundary; (b) Shelve and transfer to a younger sibling — rejected because relationship investment isn't transferable. NEXT STEP: Run as a 6-hr/week venture through senior spring; document SOPs so I could transfer to a recommended peer if I attend a college that limits external work; revenue funds first-year college book budget. Honest commitment: I will revisit the 'shelve' option at end of Q1 of college if hours-per-week exceed 8.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Decision + evidence + alternatives + next step + honest revisit-trigger. - **2:** All 4 elements present, one weak. - **1:** Decision without alternatives or evidence.

Performance Task: Capstone Defense (30-min presentation + Q&A).

Child delivers a 30-minute Capstone Defense covering: 90-day operating plan with 4 weekly variance reports, founder's leadership statement, and a Launch-or-Learn decision. Faces 10-min panel Q&A. **Rubric:** Pitch Presentation Rubric (Grade 12, full): (1) all 6 criteria scored at 3 or 4, (2) panel Q&A handled with evidence, (3) Launch-or-Learn defended with alternatives considered, (4) leadership statement names values + decision rules. **Strand outcome:** OSO + LTO + LRCI.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*In your defense, the panel asks: 'What would have to be true for you to walk away from this venture in 6 months?' Write the answer in 3 sentences with falsifiable criteria.*" Targets the Cash voice's "what would have to be true" framing at full stretch.

Total this grade: 12 MC + 8 SA + 4 Performance Tasks + 4 Extensions = 28 items.